

Defund culture: A radical proposal

Gary Hall

Calls to expand public investment in the arts often treat the existing cultural and institutional landscape as a given. In *Defund Culture*, Gary Hall challenges this assumption, asking instead: What kinds of culture are being supported, through which institutions, and to whose benefit?

In doing so, the book foregrounds the structural inequalities that shape Britain's creative and intellectual life. Drawing on critical theory, political philosophy, and cultural policy, Hall shows how the dominance of white, male, middle- and upper-class voices in the arts, media, and academy is sustained through longstanding funding arrangements and institutional hierarchies. Expanding access within this system—however well intentioned—will not, on its own, produce structural change.

Rather than offering a programme of reform, *Defund Culture* explores what it might mean to disinvest from cultural institutions as they currently operate. Taking cues from abolitionist calls to defund the police, Hall proposes redistributing resources away from elite institutions and toward more collective, commons-oriented, and radically relational alternatives grounded in redistribution, institutional transformation, and epistemic pluriversality.

Gary Hall is Professor of Media at Coventry University. His work sits at the intersection of critical theory, media philosophy, and cultural politics. He is the author of *Culture in Bits* (2002), *Digitize This Book!* (2008), and *Pirate Philosophy* (2016), and co-founder of the open-access journal *Culture Machine* and Open Humanities Press.

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Why the arts are so white, male, and
middle-class—and what we can do
about it

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